

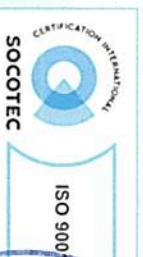


**ACCREDITING AGENCY OF CHARTERED COLLEGES
AND UNIVERSITIES IN THE PHILIPPINES, INC.**

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SUMMARY OF FINDINGS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

SUC: BICOL UNIVERSITY

ADDRESS: Legazpi City, Albay

CAMPUS: Legazpi City Campus

PROGRAM: Bachelor of Science in Meteorology

TYPE OF SURVEY: 1st Survey

DATE OF SURVEY: December 1-5, 2025



AREA OF ACCREDITATION	STRENGTHS	AREAS NEEDING IMPROVEMENT	RECOMMENDATIONS
AREA I: VISION, MISSION, GOALS, AND OBJECTIVES	1. The Vision, Mission, Goals, and Objectives are clearly articulated and realistically attainable, defining what the university aspires to become in the future and the type of graduates it aims to develop. 2. The program's objective is clearly defined, specifying the expected competencies and attributes required of its graduates.	1. It is encouraged that the VMGO be included in all formal communications to help promote its wider dissemination. 2. It is recommended that the VMGO also be displayed in strategic locations within the municipality to enhance visibility and ensure wider dissemination. 3. There appears to be limited evidence indicating the extent of stakeholder participation in the formulation of the VMGO, suggesting that the process may not have fully engaged the various sectors of the academic community, industry partners, alumni, and other relevant groups whose inputs are vital	1. The VMGO should be consistently included in all formal communications, such as letters, memoranda, and announcements, to promote greater awareness and ensure its wider dissemination among both internal and external stakeholders. 2. The VMGO should be prominently displayed in strategic locations within the municipality, such as public bulletin boards, community centers, and partner institutions, to strengthen visibility and extend its dissemination beyond the campus. 3. To address the limited evidence of stakeholder participation in the formulation of the VMGO, it is suggested that the university establish more inclusive mechanisms, such as focus group discussions, surveys, and consultative meetings, to actively involve faculty,

		in ensuring that the statements truly reflect the shared vision and aspirations of the institution. 4. There is no available evidence demonstrating stakeholders' awareness and acceptance of the VMGO, which raises concerns about the extent to which these guiding statements are understood, supported, and embraced by the different sectors of the academic community, and external partners.	students, alumni, industry partners, and community representatives in future reviews and revisions. 4. The institution may consider conducting orientation programs, information campaigns, and feedback sessions that emphasize the significance of the VMGO and highlight how each sector contributes to realizing the university's Mission and Vision.
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AREA OF ACCREDITATION	STRENGTHS	AREAS NEEDING IMPROVEMENT	RECOMMENDATIONS
AREA II: FACULTY	1. The institution thoughtfully recognizes and rewards faculty achievements through well-structured incentives, including those who successfully publish articles in refereed or Scopus-indexed journals, as well as retirement cash awards. 2. The permanent faculty in the BS Meteorology program possess exceptional qualifications, demonstrating expertise and a strong academic background that greatly enhances the quality of education and research within the program.	1. The majority of its core faculty (BS Meteorology) is employed on a part-time or temporary basis, which may affect continuity and consistency in instruction and student support. 2. During the evaluation, several faculty members were found to be holding expired professional licenses, which may impact the program's credibility and compliance with regulatory standards. 3. The program lacks a formal provision for incentives to compensate faculty members who take on overload teaching responsibilities, which may affect faculty motivation and workload management. 4. The program currently lacks clear guidelines regarding the amount of preparation time allocated within the existing faculty workload, which may lead to inconsistent workload distribution and impact teaching quality.	1. Prioritize the recruitment and retention of full-time permanent faculty to strengthen academic stability and enhance the overall quality of the program. 2. Implement a systematic process to ensure timely renewal of all faculty licenses and provide support or incentives to encourage continuous professional certification. 3. Establish a clear policy that provides appropriate incentives or remuneration for overload teaching to recognize faculty efforts and promote a balanced workload. 4. Develop and implement standardized guidelines that define preparation time expectations to ensure fair workload allocation and support effective course delivery.



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		5. There is limited evidence of faculty actively maintaining memberships in professional and scientific organizations, which may restrict opportunities for professional development and networking. 6. The program lacks established mechanisms for the systematic production and effective utilization of instructional materials, which may hinder the consistency and quality of teaching resources.	5. Encourage and support faculty participation in relevant organizations to enhance their professional growth and keep the program aligned with current industry and academic standards. 6. Develop clear processes and support systems for creating, reviewing, and integrating instructional materials to enhance teaching effectiveness and student learning.
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AREA III: CURRICULUM AND INSTRUCTION		1. The program currently lacks a Certificate of Program Compliance (COPC) issued by the Commission on Higher Education (CHED), which is crucial for validating the program's adherence to regulatory standards. 2. The evidence submitted for Area III – Curriculum does not align with the established benchmark statements, indicating gaps in curriculum documentation or implementation. 3. The accreditor was unable to provide a thorough and objective assessment due to the evidence uploaded in the Google Drive not complying with the benchmark statements.	1. For immediate action, prioritize the application for the COPC and ensure all requirements are met to secure this certification, thereby enhancing the program's legitimacy and recognition. 2. Conduct a comprehensive review and alignment of the curriculum with benchmark standards, ensuring all supporting documents and practices fully comply with required criteria for quality assurance. 3. Carefully review and update all submitted documents to ensure full compliance with the benchmark requirements, facilitating a more accurate and comprehensive evaluation.



AREA OF ACCREDITATION	STRENGTHS	AREAS NEEDING IMPROVEMENT	RECOMMENDATIONS
AREA IV: SUPPORT TO STUDENTS	1. The graduates aspiring to pursue further studies received substantial assistance in gaining admission to their preferred institution.	1. The Document Submitted are not organized according to the required AACUP survey Instrument. This misalignment limits the ability of the accreditor to verify evidence efficiently and hinders the objective of program compliance. 2. Records of students' programs, orientations, counseling sessions, career guidance initiatives, and student development activities were limited. The lack of documented evaluations and feedback mechanisms prevents verification of service quality and outcomes. 3. Evidence of regular monitoring, assessment, or continuous improvement efforts for students' services was not clearly shown.	1. Reorganized all files based on the structure and parameters of the AACUP Instrument. Use clear labeling, categorization, and cross-referencing to facilitate easier validation and ensure the evidence directly supports each indicator. 2. Established a systematic process for recording student development activities, counseling sessions, orientations, and training programs, including attendance sheets, activity designs, reports, photos, and post activity evaluations. 3. Create a standard monitoring and assessment tool to regularly evaluate the effectiveness of the student services.



		4. Documents demonstrating how data are collected, analyzed, and used for service improvement were neither provided nor completed.	4. Strengthen the documentation systems for data management by ensuring that complete evidence of data collection, analysis, and utilization is consistently compiled and made accessible.
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AREA V: RESEARCH	1. The program demonstrated robust research productivity, evidenced by faculty studies that have been published in peer-reviewed journals and presented at international conferences. This reflects a strong research culture and commitment to contributing to the global body of knowledge. 2. The research program benefits from substantial institutional support.	1. The program lacks evidence of its research, thus making it difficult to determine alignment between ongoing studies and the institutional research agenda. 2. There is no program-based research journal where the research outputs of faculty and students can be published.	1. Develop and formalized Research Agenda that clearly outlines areas, goals, and research direction of the program. 2. Established a program-based research journal with defined policies, a review process, and a publication schedule.

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AREA VI: EXTENSION AND COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT	1. The program maintains strong and active linkages for community engagement, as demonstrated by its involvement in the SARAI Project I partnership with UPLB. 2. This collaboration reflects the program's commitment to meaningful outreach and its support for community development.	1. The program does not have a clearly defined flagship extension project that illustrates how it addresses community needs and aligns with the program objectives. 2. Documentation of community needs assessment is lacking, making it difficult to ensure that the extension activities are evidence-based and responsive. 3. Monitoring and evolution of extension activities are insufficient, limiting the ability to assess effectiveness and impact. 4. Visibility of extension outputs is limited, reducing recognition of the program's accomplishments.	1. Develop and implement a flagship extension program with a structured plan, clear objectives, and measurable outcomes to demonstrate the program's community impact. 2. Conduct systematic community needs assessment and maintain complete records to guide extension planning and implementations. 3. Establish a structured monitoring and evaluation framework with specific indicators for outputs, outcomes, and community impact to track and improve extension initiatives. 4. Create platforms such as an annual report, newsletter, or online portal to showcase extension outputs, best practices, and community benefits.

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		5. Records of stakeholders' participation, partnership, and engagement in extension activities are incomplete.	5. Strengthen documentation of MOA, partner involvement, and beneficiary participation to support transparency, collaboration, and program credibility.
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AREA VII: LIBRARY	1. The library is supported by a competent pool of librarians who ensure the smooth and efficient operation of library services. 2. The use of a centralized and integrated library system stands out as a best practice, greatly enhancing both the efficiency and accessibility of library resources across the institution. 3. The well-organized and user-friendly packaging of documents reflects the campus's strong commitment to systematic, professional, and service-oriented information management. 4. It is also commendable that the library operates in its own dedicated building, offering a conducive, functional, and well-structured space for learning, research, and various library services.	1. The MOUs for international linkages presented have already expired and require renewal. 2. Continuous updating of library resources, furniture, and fixtures is necessary to maintain relevance and functionality. 3. The library is temporarily housing the Children's Library, which may affect the intended academic environment.	1. The library is encouraged to renew all expired Memoranda of Understanding and establish new linkages with relevant institutions and organizations to strengthen resource sharing, service enhancement, and professional collaboration. 2. Continue updating library resources by ensuring at least three copies per book title, along with regular upgrades of furniture and fixtures. This will help maintain a current, functional, and user-friendly library environment that effectively supports the needs of its clientele. 3. As an academic library, the presence of a Children's Library may disrupt the academic focus of students.

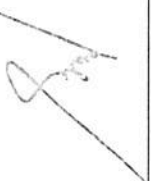


	5. The presence of a Network Center within the University Library that serves the entire system is admirable. 6. Overall, the library demonstrates significant strengths that align with institutional goals and uphold a high standard of library service delivery.	4. The existing library manual needs revision to reflect current policies and practices. 5. Some of the evidence presented includes outdated documents and resources.	4. While the library is spacious, it currently lacks modern furniture and features typically found in learning commons. For a large university like Bicol University, investing in contemporary furniture, collaborative spaces, and even a small in-library coffee lounge would greatly enrich the learning atmosphere and student experience. 5. Revise the library manual to incorporate updated guidelines and policies, including those related to services in the new-normal or technology-enhanced learning environment.
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			6. Limit submitted evidence to materials within the last three years and remove outdated items that are five years old or older. For lists of books or e-resources, include only materials based on CHED required standards, except for perpetual resources that remain valid despite age.
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AREA VIII: PHYSICAL PLANT AND FACILITIES	1. The virtual tour showcasing the various offices was exceptionally impressive, particularly highlighting key areas such as (a) the Meteorology Laboratory, (b) the Physics, Chemistry, and Biology laboratories, (c) the office of the students' affairs, (d) the library, (e) the Medical and Dental Office, and (f) the Sport Facilities.	1. The current contract for janitorial services is outdated, which may affect the quality and consistency of facility maintenance. 2. The program lacks a valid Electrical Safety Certificate from the Bureau of Fire Protection, which is essential for ensuring compliance with safety regulations and protecting the campus community. 3. There is no documented evidence that school facilities undergo periodic pest control and inspection, which could pose health risks and affect the learning environment. 4. The program lacks evidence of accessible toilet fixtures designed for persons with disabilities (PWDs), which may limit inclusivity and compliance with accessibility standards.	1. Review and update the janitorial service contract to align with the program's current needs and standards, ensuring a clean and well-maintained learning environment. 2. Secure the necessary certification promptly and establish a regular renewal process to maintain full compliance with fire safety standards. 3. Implement a regular pest control schedule with proper documentation to ensure a safe, hygienic, and conducive environment for students and staff. 4. If the budget warrants, construction of restrooms for PWDs should be prioritized to ensure a safe and inclusive environment for all clients.



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		5. The business and sanitary permit for operations of the food center is outdated, potentially affecting the program's legal compliance and institutional credibility.	5. The university shall strictly implement its policy, "No permit, no business operation." The permit should be update and it must be visible for the customers to see.
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AREA IX: LABORATORIES	1. The comprehensive provisions for the disposal of waste materials, including both hazardous and solid waste, are highly commendable. 2. The laboratory technician and staff are exceptionally qualified, notably featuring a dedicated resident calibrator for laboratory equipment and apparatus.	1. The program lacks a comprehensive and updated inventory of apparatuses, equipment, and materials that align with the Commission on Higher Education Memorandum Order (CMO) standards, making it difficult to verify laboratory resources against required specifications. 2. The maintenance and repair personnel currently assigned to the department hold expired licenses, raising concerns about compliance with professional standards and the quality of maintenance services. 3. The program lacks documented evidence of annual demonstrations and training on the proper use of fire extinguishers, first-aid kits, and other emergency procedures, which may compromise campus safety preparedness.	1. Conduct a thorough audit of laboratory resources and maintain a detailed list that ensures full compliance with CMO guidelines, supporting effective teaching and hands-on learning experiences. 2. Ensure that all maintenance staff renew their licenses promptly and establish a monitoring system to maintain valid certification for personnel responsible for equipment upkeep. 3. Implement and regularly document mandatory annual safety training sessions to ensure all personnel and students are well-prepared to respond effectively in emergencies.

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AREA X: ADMINISTRATION	1. The program benefits from Strong administrative support, exemplified by the approval of its University Code. It reflects the instructional alignment and adherence to regulatory requirements, ensuring the program operates under an official framework.	1. The University Code was approved in 2009 and has not been updated since, which may not reflect current institutional developments, policies, or program advancements.	1. Conduct a review and update the University code to align it with current standards, policies, and programs.

- Nothing Follows -

